

Airheads Sours Focus Group Analysis Reporting

09/12/24



+ HIGHDIVE



Today, we'll discuss:

01.
**Methodology
& Executive
Summary**

02.
**Key Learnings
Deep Dive**

03.
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Dive**

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01. Methodology & Executive Summary

Research Objective

Evaluate Airheads Sour Bars creative storyboards to identify creative optimizations and adjustments to implement before moving into production, exploring consumer perceptions related to 4 key areas.

Methodology

Conducted 7 focus groups across 18 participants

Participants were 18-34 year old non-chocolate candy lovers and non-Airheads rejectors. Most had purchased Airheads in L6M for personal consumption.

Key Learning Areas

Message Clarity: Is "sour through the chew" effectively communicated without coming across as overly sour?

Emotional Connect: Does humor resonate with our audience?

Brand Fit & Awareness: Does concept align well with the brand and help drive awareness of what Airheads stands for?

Creative Device: What are reactions to concepts that communicate "sour through chew" with or without head inflation?

Focus Group Participant Overview

18 participants were interviewed across 7 groups, with demographic breakdowns roughly to census

AGE

18-24: 28%

25-29: 28%

30-34: 44%

GENDER

Male: 50%

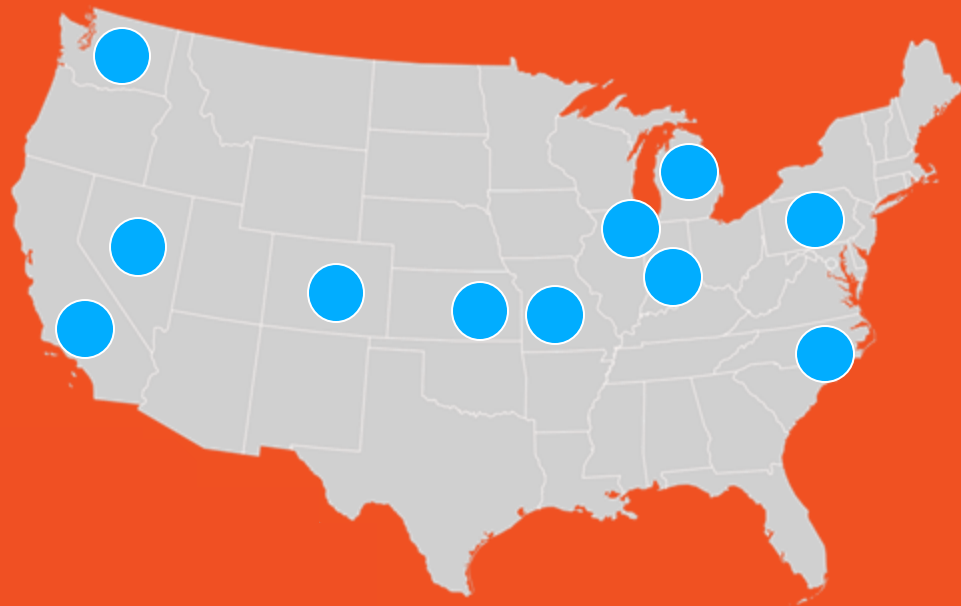
Female: 50%

ETHNICITY

White/Caucasian: 72%

Black/African-American: 17%

Hispanic: 11%



KEY LEARNINGS

Head Inflation concepts had a much stronger connection to the Airheads brand, driven by familiarity with this creative asset and associations with the balloon logo. The quirkiness of Sour on Loop created some brand association but the overall score was lower due to a disconnect on brand tone – participants missed the fun, modern image they associate with Airheads.

Head Inflation conveyed extreme sour flavor, with ratings closer to a 10/10 sour scale due to the extreme sour faces, while Sour on Loop evoked much milder sour perceptions because of the calmer setting and lack of exaggerated sour faces. Both concepts communicated long lasting sour flavor. Participants noted that they would not be disappointed if the actual sourness wasn't a 10.

Color is important for brand recognition. Participants associated the colorful, saturated palette of “Parrot” with the Airheads brand, as well as sourness in general (less so with Head Inflation). Even the packaging color conveyed different sour levels, with some participants feeling the yellow would be more sour than Airheads in green packaging.

Participants generally liked the concepts with more straightforward narratives, like in “Taxi Driver” and especially “Speed Date,” as these were easy to follow and conveyed the message clearer than more abstract concepts like “Penny Farthing” and “Infinite Pony.”

Participants related more to older characters (vs. child characters) in more mature settings that reflect their everyday lives. In the concepts that did this best – “Taxi Driver” and “Speed Date” – these helped reinforce the idea (quoted from one participant): *you don't have to be a kid to eat Airheads.*

WHAT WE HEARD

Airheads get credit as a modern brand.

Clearer is better.

Build on people's brand expectations.

Relatability brings people closer to the fun.

Head Inflation is a powerful brand asset.

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

Consumers have heart for classic Airheads but expect a fresh take. Continue to explore new and clever ways to bring the brand – especially Head Inflation – to life.

Life is already complex. Let's break up the boring with straightforward and linear narratives that make having fun easy to access. And simple visuals to tout unique product attributes.

Continue to lean into what people already know and love about the brand: that it is vibrant, silly, fun, energetic, playful, modern and visually colorful.

The more extreme things get, the more juvenile things feel, the more people struggle to find the fun. Let's take what's relatable in people's everyday lives and exaggerate it in silly and surprising ways.

Pursue new and clever ways to incorporate the distinctive Head Inflation visual into brand comms to further cement and connect Airheads with "air heads" that have more fun.

Based on the learnings from this round of qualitative research, we recommend moving forward with

HEAD INFLATION

- + **Strongest brand fit**
- + **Immediate brand recognition**
- + **High equity value**
- + **Most 'fun' and 'funniest'**
- + **Appropriate aged-up humor**
- + **Clear communication of sour flavor**

AIRHEADS SOURS NEXT STEPS

- ❑ Creative Exploration: How do we lower sour intensity perceptions while maintaining the Airheads brand personality, tone and vibrant visual identity?
- ❑ Quant Testing:
 - ❑ Test head inflation execution look and feel
 - ❑ Validate head inflation with larger sample size

02. Key Learnings Deep Dive

Airheads is perceived as a modern brand

People expect Airheads to show up with fresh ideas and a current look.

Participants resonated with everyday scenarios giving the brand credit for being modern and “with the times.”

The outlier was “Penny Farthing” because its setting was perceived as vintage and outdated. The visual tone in the concept created a disconnect between what they thought they knew of the brand (fun, modern, silly) and what they were seeing (vintage, sophisticated, bland).

It is a little bit nostalgic, while also keeping up with the times, which I like.

– Madalyn Group 5

They're innovative, because each one we've seen has been a different environment. There's not many commercials that do like something new like this.

– Joey Group 4

Clearer is better when it comes to narratives and selling brand attributes.

Participants were confused by abstract concepts and ideas that distracted them from what the ad was truly about.

“Speed Date” and “Taxi Driver’s” clear visual pucker and obvious reaction to the long-lasting sour flavor successfully communicated Airheads Sours unique product attributes.

On the other hand, in “Infinite Pony”, participants felt the concept execution was overly abstract and too distracting, drawing attention away from the sour theme.

My favorite was “Taxi Driver”. I like how there was, like a narrative I could actually somewhat grasp.

– Richard Group 8 (Referring to “Taxi Driver”)

This says it’s going to be very sour, and it’s going to continually get sour and not fade away.

– Megan Group 6 (Referring to “Speed Date”)

I would be so focused on the woman and the horse and the continuous-ness of the loop, but not so much the candy – besides the sour part that being said.

– Melissa Group 6 (Referring to “Infinite Pony”)

We can lean on what people already know about – and expect from – the brand

People expect Airheads to show up as vibrant, silly, fun, energetic, playful, modern and visually colorful.

The brand personality and visual identity is so strong that when they see an ad that doesn't align with their expectations, it throws them off.

"Parrot's" pop of bright on-brand colors and cheery tone immediately reminded people of Airheads while "Penny Farthing's" more sophisticated tone and muted palette confused them.

I definitely think it matches the Airheads brand. The commercial just looks bright and cheerful overall, which is what I think about Airheads.

- Madalyn Group 5 (Referring to "Parrot")

They don't take themselves too seriously, in a good way. Airheads is always pretty fun.

- Mason Group 8

It didn't really seem like an Airheads commercial. It's too boring and muted for Airheads. Like, it's too plain.

- Joey Group 4 (on why Penny Farthing is not a good fit)

I mean, it's Airheads so how sour can it really be?

- Ann Group 3

Relatability brings people closer to the fun.

When people can identify with the on-screen talent and see themselves in the scenarios depicted, they believe Airheads is talking to them (people their age).

Adult talent in adult scenarios resonates more with adults, like with “Speed Date” and “Taxi Driver” which show adults in adult settings.

That said, people have strong childhood associations with the brand and expressed that all concepts would be appropriate for all ages. believe that though the humor was aged-up for adults, it could be appreciated by all ages.

I think it's appealing to an older generation. The old commercials were a kid playing outside, like we did when we were kids, and then their head would get big. Where now it's speed dating, almost pulling things that we have to deal with now as an adult, but adding a small part of our childhood with the big head. It's adding a little bit new while still being relatable.

- Megan Group 6 (Referring to 'Speed Date')

I think it's aimed more towards young adults. Although I think some children might like the visual aspect of it. They might think that's interesting, but it doesn't seem like something that's typically marketed towards kids.

- Sophie Group 7 (Referring to 'Penny Farthing')

[Speed Date] is my favorite because she's on a date. That's something I would do, so it's like, relatable.

- Alyssa Group 5 (Referring to 'Speed Date')

This would definitely appeal to me more as an adult because the commercials that I saw were always, like, focused on kids.. So I guess as an adult, it feels like they're branching out.

- Mike Group 7

Head Inflation is a powerful brand asset.

The Head Inflation visual lends itself to much stronger Airheads brand association driven by familiarity with this classic brand asset.

Head Inflation concepts evoked stronger sour associations, with participants perceiving it to be an extremely sour candy, largely due to the scrunched sour face seen as a reaction to eating it.

"Parrot's" vibrant color hinted at a slightly more sour flavor, but without the sour face, the product was still viewed as only moderately sour.

You can definitely tell that it's an Airheads commercial, even without seeing the Airheads thing, and I don't know, to me, it's the blown up head.

-Richard Group 8

...it's similar to the commercials I was always used to seeing where the heads get all big after eating them, so it makes me think of that as well as mixing with the sour.

-Madalyn Group 5 (Referring to 'Speed Date')

I mean, everything about this one just makes more sense for an Airheads commercial, with whole big head thing..

-Briton Group 7

I remember the balloon in the commercials growing up. Those were always on. It just feels very familiar.

-Mike Group 7

I like when the head is getting bigger, it's kind of a balloon head and it makes you think of Airheads right away.

-Alyssa Group 5 (on favorites)

03. Concept Deep Dive

Concept Summary

	CONCEPT & RATING	MESSAGE CLARITY + SOURNESS	BRAND FIT	FUN & HUMOR
	"Taxi Driver" 4	"Sour as you chew and chew" message was understood through the VO, but the exaggerated sour expression did convey extreme sourness	Strong brand fit: Head Inflation visual, aged up scenarios, general silliness of the man's face and comical VO	Strong fun and funny ratings, with the humor coming from the exaggerated sour face and humorous VO
	"Speed Date" 3.4*	The voice-over communicated "sour as you chew" message, but the exaggerated face expressed extreme sourness	Strong brand fit: Head Inflation visual, aged-up scenarios and the surprise of the face popping out of the head	Setting and narrative were seen as particularly fun and funny *Some concerns about the specific face visuals
	"Parrot" 3.7	"Sour on Loop" message was extremely clear via the VO and bright, vibrant color palette The color and wackiness of the parrot/man visual also contributed to sour perceptions	Moderate brand fit: saturated colors and silly animation	Seen as colorful and fun, with the humor coming from the twist of the man on the parrot's shoulder
	"Infinite Pony" 3.6	Most understood "Sour on Loop" message from the VO, but the elegant and sophisticated tone conveyed weaker sour perceptions	Weaker brand fit: sophisticated visuals that gave associations of perfume or hair product ads	Slightly fun through the appealing visuals, but no specific funny elements stood out
	"Penny Farthing" 3.5	Most understood "Sour on Loop" message from the VO, but calm, vintage setting conveyed weaker sour perceptions	Weaker brand fit: more subdued visuals and desaturated color The animation did show some connection	Not seen as fun or funny Lacked any overt humor elements beyond the surreal visual

Top-performing concepts exaggerated relatable scenarios with vibrant, visually entertaining stories

"Taxi Driver"



- Familiarity with the Head Inflation asset drove strong appeal
- Many enjoyed the humor of the man's face and comical VO
- Most found the setting relatable, especially for older audiences

"Speed Date"



- Many enjoyed the humorous narrative and head popping visual
- Head Inflation visual keyed them in to Airheads associations
- Setting was somewhat relatable, especially for older audiences

"Parrot"



- Many found the bright, vibrant colors appealing and connected this to the Airheads brand
- The playful twist of the man on the parrot shoulder was a hit

The lower-performing concepts were more abstract and less overt humor

"Infinite Pony"



- Poor reception due to its abstract execution creating confusion
- The infinite loop was memorable, but was less clear in its messaging
- Weaker brand connection with calm imagery and elegant vibes

"Penny Farthing"



- Calm, "vintage" theme drove a weaker brand association
- Looping visual was memorable, but some found it too repetitive
- Lacked overt humor elements

Concept One

“Penny Farthing”



The old-fashioned and sophisticated imagery didn't align with the Airheads brand

The “Penny Farthing” concept was not as adventurous or out-of-left-field in terms of visuals or concept, leading many participants to rate lower than other concepts.

Many felt the ad came across as outdated, which caused a disconnect with the fun and modern feel of the current Airheads brand.

In particular, some small details of the ad such as the man's outfit and vintage penny farthing led to participants feeling like Airheads was abandoning their fun branding for a more elevated, sophisticated feel.

AVERAGE RATING
3.5 out of 5



A word cloud of feedback terms for the Airheads ad. The words are arranged in a cluster, with 'VINTAGE' being the largest and most central word in red. Other words include 'TRIPPY' (large, blue), 'BIZARRE' (medium, blue), 'TIMELESS' (medium, orange), 'MONTY PYTHON' (small, red), 'DISTRACTING' (medium, orange), 'REPETITIVE' (medium, red), and 'BLAND' (large, blue).

While the ad message was clear, it didn't particularly resonate with participants

- Participants generally understood the “sour on loop” message that the candy will remain sour, but the vintage theme detracted from the core message with many focusing on the disconnect with their prior associations with Airheads.
- Additionally, the calm, sophisticated tone contributed to perceptions that this candy may not be sour at all, revealing issues with the product associations.

The ‘Sour on Loop’ message is clear. When you take the first bite, the sourness hits you. But even when you don’t think it’s sour anymore, you still get a big burst of sourness on each bite.

– Mason Group 8

The ad just doesn’t make the candy seem as sour. I like the white blazer on the guy and the bike, but it seems bland. It can use more energy.

– Sophie Group 7

Participants did not feel the ad aligned with the vibrant and contemporary Airheads brand they already know

- While the trippy looping visuals did have some brand connection, many felt the ad was too calm and sophisticated for a more fun brand like Airheads.
 - Many suggested that increasing the colorfulness of the ad or incorporating crazier elements would provide a stronger association with the brand's silly vibes.

This gentleman in the ad looks more on the elegant side. The ad has a classiness to it. Maybe Airheads are trying to appeal to a classier audience.

- Alan Group 1

I feel like the ad is misaligned, since the packaging of Airheads is a bright balloon. In this ad, there's a guy in a suit and a lack of color, which just feels more mature or watered down.

- Madalyn Group 5

The repetitive visuals of the ad elicited more monotony than amusement

- Participants did not find the ad particularly funny, instead describing it as “bland” and lacking energy, and instead were looking for more interaction and crazier setting that could increase appeal and brand connection.
- Some also noted that the “sophisticated” visuals of the ad, like the man’s bike and apparel, felt a bit strange, and a few expressed concerns that this would not related to a younger audience.

I don't think this ad is as relatable to the younger crowd. It's not as attention grabbing, and kids aren't used to seeing this vintage bicycle.

- Megan Group 7

To me, this ad misses the mark. I don't think the candy is sour at all after seeing the ad. Also, it's just bland, like it's an ad on PBS.

- Angel Group 6

Concept Two

“Parrot”



Vibrant visuals and a clear, playful narrative won hearts but lack of product information did not

The “Parrot” ad was seen as a playful, intriguing ad due to its colorful visuals and clear communication of the continuous sour theme. Participants seemed to either love or hate the ad, making it the ad with the most diverse feedback.

Most participants were pleasantly surprised by the “pop of color” and rated the ad highly for its youthful and quirky concept and funny VO, which they thought aligned with the Airheads brand.

While participants found the ad amusing and engaging, some wished the ad put more emphasis on the candy itself.

AVERAGE RATING
3.7 out of 5

A word cloud of feedback for the Parrot ad. The words are arranged in a cluster, with 'PLAYFUL' and 'COLORFUL' being the largest and most central. 'VIBRANT' is above 'PLAYFUL', 'RIDICULOUS' is to the left, and 'ANNOYING' is to the right. 'FUNNY' is to the right of 'COLORFUL', 'REPETITIVE' is below 'COLORFUL', and 'ABSURD' is to the right of 'REPETITIVE'. The words are in various colors including red, orange, blue, and brown.

VIBRANT
RIDICULOUS PLAYFUL ANNOYING
COLORFUL FUNNY
REPETITIVE ABSURD

Participants understood the concept, but some felt it lacked reasons to try Airheads

- Participants grasped the “Sour on Loop” concept well, connecting the repetitive loop visuals with the continuous sour flavor of the candy. Many participants also felt pleasantly surprised by the visual loop, since many didn’t expect to see a person on the parrot’s shoulder.
- However, the concept did not feel the repetitive loop visuals were enough to convince them to try an Airheads sour bar. Participants wished the ad put more emphasis on the product itself, perhaps by showing the candy more prominently.

From the ad, I can tell this is going to be sour, since it's like it's going to another dimension. In the infinite loop, it's like an illusion that's transporting you places.

- Jordan Group 4

I think it would help to tell us a little more about the actual product, since the ad is pretty vague. If you went into more detail, it would help explain the experience differently.

- Sophie Group 7

The youthful and playful imagery connected well to the established Airheads brand

- Most said that this concept fit well with Airheads' fun and quirky brand personality, and some mentioned seeing past Airheads commercials with similar youthful energy and silliness.
- The saturated, bright colors also aligned with Airheads' established brand, with participants referred to this "pop of color" as a reason why this ad would easily catch their attention.
 - The brightness and vibrant colors also keyed participants in that this is a sour product.

Based on the colors of the ad, the candy just seems more sour. And adding the craziness of the guy sitting on the parrot shoulder gives me the hint that 'hey, this is wicked sour.'

- Anne Group 3

I definitely think it matches the Airheads brand. The commercial just looks bright and cheerful overall, which is what I think about Airheads.

- Madalyn Group 5

Participants felt a sense of pleasant surprise from the visuals and unexpected visual loop

- While this concept wasn't laugh-out-loud funny, most participants found the unexpected flip of the man on the parrot's shoulder to be a funny element and contributed to memorability
- Some participants also felt the parrot squawking "sour on loop" was particularly funny; however, it was a bit divisive, as a few found this aspect to be a bit annoying

I don't think the ad is funny, but it's cutesy. It's something that would make me smile, since I love animals and parrots.

- Alan Group 1

I would have to say that the parrot squawking 'sour on loop' over and over is a bit annoying. But I think the infinite loop concept is innovative.

- Joey Group 4

Concept Three

“Infinite Pony”



Creative visuals led to high memorability, but low consideration for the product

The “Infinite Pony” concept differentiated itself from other candy ads, with participants saying they are likely to remember the surreal visuals.

The beauty of the stallion and woman were also appealing, but these visuals and the calm tone tended to be associated with perfume or hair product ads more so than candy.

Participants also felt the concept execution was overly abstract and too distracting, drawing attention away from the sour theme. Some even described the ad as “weird” or “bizarre”, feeling that the ad overdid some of the surreal visuals.

AVERAGE RATING

3.6 out of 5



A word cloud visualization of participant feedback. The words are arranged in a cluster, with 'STRETCHY' being the largest and most central word in blue. Other prominent words include 'WEIRD' in large orange letters, 'MIRROR' in large red letters, and 'BIZARRE' in orange. Smaller words include 'UNIQUE', 'UPLIFTING', 'STRANGE', 'REPETITIVE', and 'BEAUTY'.

Surreal visuals overpowered the ad's message for many participants

- While almost all participants understood the concept of the infinite loop, the surreal visuals overshadowed the message itself, causing participants to remember the visual rather than the product itself.
- The visuals also didn't connect as strongly to continuous sour flavor, so while it would drive memorability, it would be less likely to promote consideration of the product itself.

*I think the message is sort of the shock value itself.
Like the beautiful horse and beautiful woman
eating a sour Airheads generate shock value and
captures the imagination.*

- Alan Group 1

*I would be so focused on the woman and the horse
and the continuous-ness of the loop, but not so
much the candy – besides the sour part.*

- Melissa Group 6

Participants had mixed feelings about the ad's connection to their preconceived Airheads image

- While some participants felt the ad fit with Airheads' quirky and unserious brand image, others felt that the fantastical visuals did not fit with past Airheads creative work.
 - Those who were familiar with Airheads' head inflation ads of the past were more tolerant of the fantasy element, but those less familiar felt the ad was just bizarre and not fitting Airheads.

I think the ad is really fun with a cool concept. It feels on brand for Airheads, and that makes me think sour. But it doesn't make it seem as sour as other ads.

– Mike Group 7

When I first watched it, I thought it was selling an expensive product. But then it pops up that it's for Airheads. That was funny, and it's interesting Airheads can match any vibe.

– Madalyn Group 5

Participants also had a mixed emotional reaction to the ad's surreal visuals and message

- Emotional reactions were varied, with some participants being distracted and confused by the stretchy, mirror-like visuals of the ad, while others found the attractive woman riding the horse appealing.
- While this concept was seen as mildly amusing, it didn't elicit any strong laughs, and much of the humor was based in the absurdity and surprise that the ad was for Airheads.
 - The visuals did contribute to a strong “wow” factor, but sometimes devolved into bewilderment.

I'm biased because I'm a guy, and it was a pretty girl on a horse. I'm gonna stop and watch the ad, but it feels like candy is the afterthought of the ad.

- Angel Group 6

It would be easy to watch it on loop. Because it's repetitive that if I were scrolling on TikTok, I would find myself watching it a few times without knowing where it started or stopped.

- Megan Group 6

Concept Four

“Taxi Driver”



Taxi Driver blends relatable humor with memorable Airheads silliness

“Taxi Driver” had strong ratings for overall appeal, with the juxtaposition of the banal, relatable scenario with the craziness of the scrunched face to be particularly funny.

Many described this concept to be silly and weird, driven by the comical scrunched sour face and humorous VO, and felt like this tone (along with the inflated head) keyed them in that this was an Airheads ad.

While most had positive associations with the weirdness, a few found the face switching and the man’s face on the back of the head to be a bit creepy, but was unexpected enough to promote memorability.

AVERAGE RATING
4 out of 5

A word cloud centered around the word 'SILLY' in large blue letters. Surrounding it are other words in orange and red: 'WEIRD' (top), 'FUN' (top-left), 'CREEPY' (bottom-left), 'COOL' (bottom-left), 'FUNNY' (bottom), 'UNEXPECTED' (top-right), and 'PUCKER' (right).

While the “sour as you chew” VO was understood, sour perceptions were high due to the scrunched face visual

- Participants were easily able to understand the message that this candy remains sour as you chew, largely due to the clear message in the VO
 - However, the overly scrunched face does contribute to sour perceptions, with the majority of participants believing this would be an extremely sour candy based on that

This says that every bite is going to be just as sour as the first one. Other sour candies, you chew them and they become sweet. But this seems like it's saying that every bite is going to be just as sour as the first one.

– Briton Group 7

I'm getting a strong sour vibe out of it coming from the face in the upper right hand corner, the scrunch face.

– Kaylie Group 8

Quirky vibes help connect to Airheads, but the less vibrant colors and less energetic setting fall short

- This concept closely fits Airheads' quirky nature, and the inflated head asset solidified this strong brand connection
- However, some felt it was less vibrant and colorful than other concepts, leading to a slightly weaker brand association
 - Also, while the setting was relatable (especially for older audiences), for a few it didn't quite match the expected energetic feel of Airheads

You can definitely tell that it's an Airheads commercial, even without seeing the Airhead, and the blown up head and the scrunched up face thing kind of shows that it's an Airheads commercial more than it shows that it's overly sour.

- Briton Group 7

I feel like this one just doesn't have as much color and as much like fun [as the other concepts]."

- Madelyn Group 5

The funny VO and comical visuals contributed to strong perceptions of humor

- While “Taxi Cab” is still more amusing than laugh out loud funny, many rated this concept as the funniest of the bunch, driven by the comically large head and the twist of the man’s face switching to the back
 - Many also found the “where to, buddy?” VO to be particularly funny and unexpected
- Some also felt like the juxtaposition of a normal taxi ride with the extreme physical comedy was another funny element

I mean, I just, I, like the nonsensically sized head and like his face sucking through the back like, it's just weird, but in a good way.

- Mason Group 8

The face on the back of the bald guy's head and the large head in the first image is sort of like funny meme humor, yeah. So this is something that that I would find funny.

- Alan Group 1

Concept Five

“Speed Dating”



The relatable speed dating scenario amuses despite unsettling visuals

The main draw of “Speed Dating” was its high relatability, with many seeing it as a scenario that, while funny, was also one they could see themselves in or have experienced personally.

This concept also had strong rated for its humor, largely through the sour face visual and the humorous narrative.

While most found the visuals engaging, some had negative associations with the face on the back of the head, connecting it to horror movies like “The Grudge”. Many also found the face visual in the first panel to be off-putting, largely due to the “scary” eyes.

AVERAGE RATING

3.4 out of 5



Sours' lasting punch was evoked via the narration and humorous facial exaggeration

- Similar to “Taxi Driver”, this concept effectively communicated that the candy remains sour as you chew, largely through the “sour as you chew and chew” VO
 - The head inflation with the scrunched face also added a humorous, exaggerated touch that keyed consumers into the sourness of the product, but did drive a strong sour perception
- The more mature speed dating setting also said “you don’t have to be a kid to eat Airheads” to a handful of participants, reinforcing the slightly older target

This says it's going to be very sour, and it's going to continually get sour and not fade away. It make it seem like the more you eat it, the more sour it will be.

- Megan Group 6

This makes it seem like it starts out less sour, but gets more sour. Because she starts out normal, then she had the crinkle face, then she goes to the extreme of her head turning around.

- Anne Group 3

Speed Dating works by blending brand identity with exaggerated playfulness

- This concept was seen as perfectly fitting Airheads' fun and playful brand identity, with the exaggerated sour face resonating well with participants
- Most participants also easily connected the sour scrunched face with Airheads traditional inflated head asset

I am connecting it very strongly [to Airheads], where the head is getting bigger and it's kind of a balloon head makes you think of Airheads right away.

- Alyssa Group 5

This is perfect. This fits them perfectly. Basically just reinforces everything I already know about the brand and I come to expect.

- Angel Group 6

Speed Dating amuses with the humorous sour face design and engaging narrative

- While not laugh-out-loud funny, many participants found this concept to be amusing, largely because of the humorous twist of the face popping out the back of the head and the comical sour face design
- Others found humor in the speed dating narrative, and felt like the more mature situation positions this concept as more relatable for an older audience

The fact that she is eating it to get away from the guy because she doesn't like him, I think that's funny. And also the kind of absurdity of the scenario where she has to look through her own hair.

- Mason Group 8

I don't think funny, but I think it's cute, and I think that this maybe appeals more to an older crowd.

- Alyssa Group 5

Next Steps

Timeline

- ASAP: Determine Kantar Quant Next Steps (timing, costs, etc.)
- F, 9/13: Kick-off Head Inflation creative revisions
- M, 9/23: Creative Review of revisions
- W, 9/25: Approval of creative for quant
- TBD: Quant Testing
- 10/14: Award Director for November Production

A full-page background image showing a person in mid-air, jumping into a calm lake. The person is shirtless and wearing dark shorts, with their arms and legs spread wide in a joyful pose. The lake is surrounded by steep, forested mountains under a clear sky. The text "THANK YOU!" is overlaid in the center.

THANK YOU!